

Santhya Pannerchelvam, Mohansundar Sankaravel, Gunathevan Elumalai
Faculty of Sports Science and Coaching, Universiti Pendidikan Sultan Idris, Malaysia

INTRODUCTION & AIMS

- Knee osteoarthritis following a previous sports-related knee injury may cause persistent pain and psychosocial distress.
- Group-based exercise offers a shared rehabilitation setting, whereas individual-based exercise provides one-to-one supervision.
- Evidence comparing these delivery formats in this population remains limited.
- Aim: compare Group-based exercise (GBE) and Individual-Based Exercise (IBE) effects on pain, depressive symptoms, anxiety symptoms and stress.

MATERIALS AND METHODS

Design

RCT

Parallel-group design

Participants

44

Age 45–65 years

INTERVENTION DETAILS

Screening

Eligibility and consent

Randomization

GBE n = 22
IBE n = 22

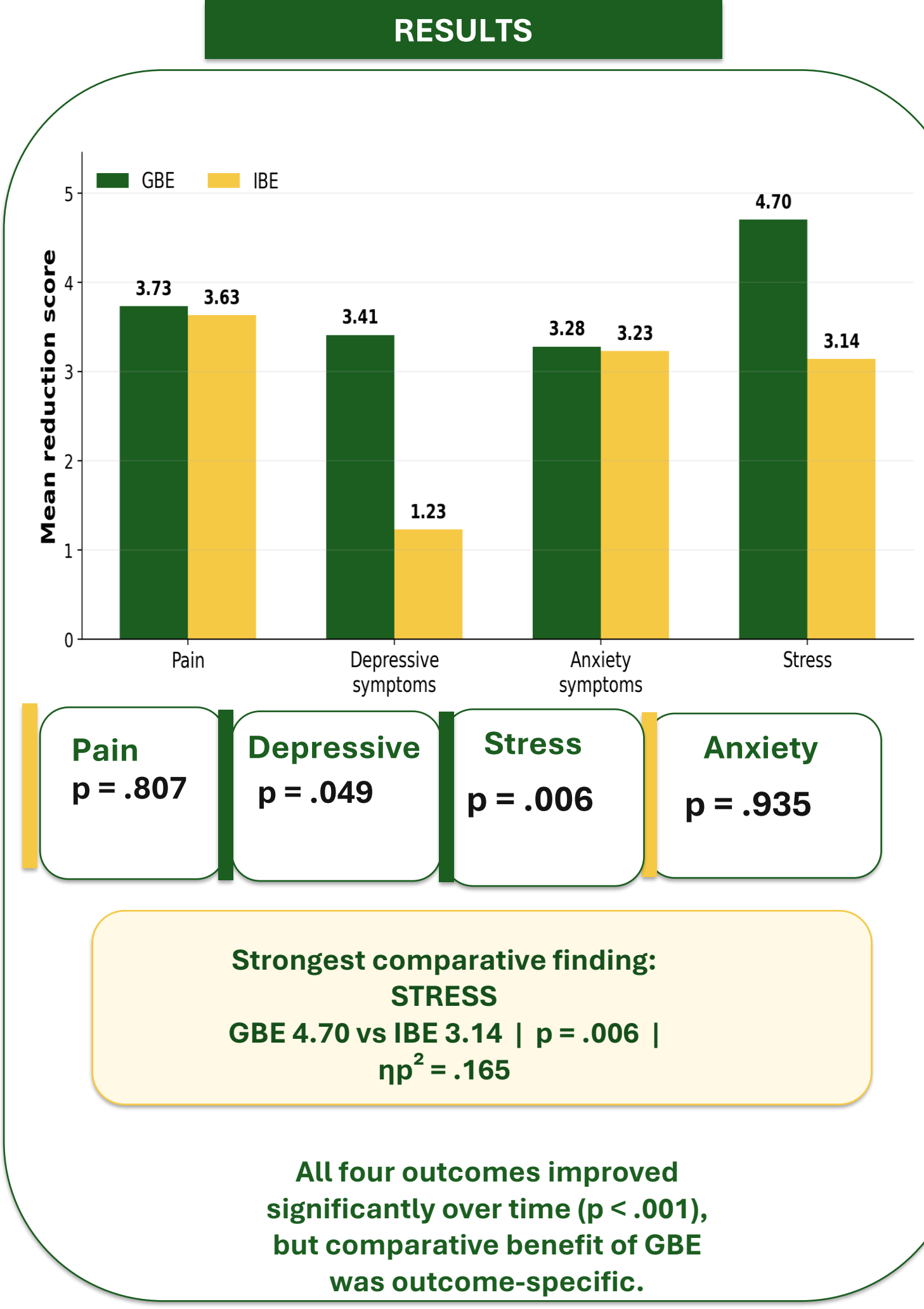
Intervention

8 weeks
3×/week
~60 min

Outcomes

VAS
DASS-21

- Both groups completed the same progressive Physiotherapy Osteoarthritis-Based Care Protocol (PTOA-BCP).
- Primary outcomes were pain (VAS) and psychosocial symptoms (DASS-21).



DISCUSSION / CONCLUSION

- Both exercise formats produced short-term reductions in pain and psychosocial symptom scores.
- GBE was not superior for pain or anxiety.
- Depressive symptoms showed a borderline advantage for GBE (p = .049).
- Stress showed the clearest added benefit of group delivery.
- GBE and IBE are complementary and should be matched to patient need, preference and rehabilitation goals.

STRENGTHS & LIMITATIONS

- Strengths: concealed allocation, blinded outcome assessment, standardized
- Limitations: small single-setting intervention , sample size , immediate post-test only, self-reported DASS-21 and unmeasured social mechanisms.

ETHICS • ACKNOWLEDGEMENT • DECLARATION

ETHICAL APPROVAL

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DECLARATION OF CONFLICT

No conflict of interest.

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CONCLUSION

Both group-based and individual-based rehabilitation improved pain and psychosocial symptom scores. Group-based rehabilitation showed its clearest added value for stress, while pain and anxiety benefits were comparable. Larger multicenter studies with longer follow-up are needed.

TAKEHOME MESSAGE

Consider group delivery hen a structured shared setting is feasible and stress is a key concern.